Jargon Buster

Average seek time: The average time required for the drive heads to move from one track to any other track.
Burst transfer rate: The maximum speed at which the data is transferred to and from the memory.
ESD (Electro Static Discharge): This usually occurs if you pass static to the drive by handling it without grounding yourself. The chips inside are sensitive and the damage caused could be permanent.
G: This is a shock specification for hard drives. When drives experience more shock than specified, they are prone to suffer damage.
Head: This is the part of the drive which can write, read, erase, record or play back data on a magnetic media.
Internal transfer rate: The speed at which the drive can transfer data from the platter to the heads and vice-versa.
Latency (Rotational): The average time taken for a disk to rotate to a desired sector.
MTBF (Mean Time Between Failures): It specifies the reliability of the drive. The higher the MTBF rating, the more reliable is your drive.
Sustained transfer rate: The speed at which data can be transferred for a sustained period of time.

plays a very important part. Therefore we calculated the value for hard drives by determining the sum of performance and features divided by the price.

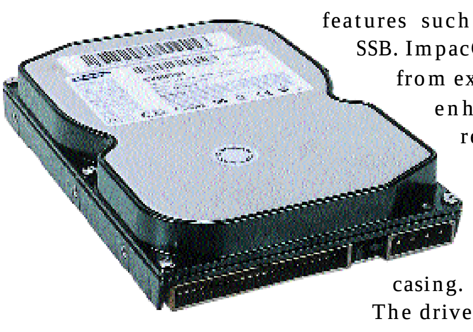
How they fared

There has been a tremendous increase in the performance and reliability in hard disks today and this has given rise to a new level of functionality and usability in computers—video and audio are applications that would run on any computer today and the price per megabyte rating is forever spirally downward. Let's take a look at how the current generation of hard disks perform across different criteria.

Features

Most hard disks include adequate protection against shock and damage during transportation and installation.

All the Samsung drives came in a shell plastic cover and included a small single-page manual for jumper identification and installation. These drives also sport features such as ImpacGuard and SSB. ImpacGuard protects the disk from external vibrations, thus enhancing its internal resistance to shocks. SSB reduces the impact of external shocks with the help of a well-designed casing.



Samsung drives incorporate technologies to shield them from internal and external shocks

The drives from Maxtor came in a box with plenty of protecting foam to shield the drive during transportation. The 5400-rpm